



Black opal

Opal is most commonly found in Australia, and comes in a range of tones, but black opal is the rarest and most valuable.



Grandidierite

Found almost only in Madagascar, this bluish-green mineral is the third most expensive gemstone on Earth.



Benitoite

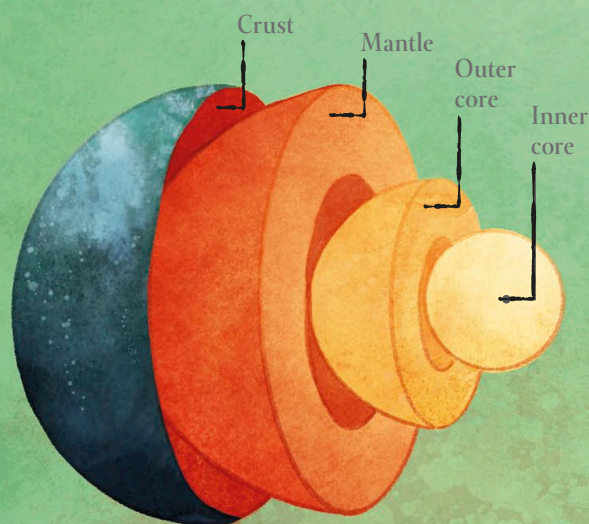
The finest examples of this mineral have been found in California. It is sometimes called "Blue Diamond."



Tanzanite

Only found by Mount Kilimanjaro in Tanzania, this violet stone is so rare it may soon be completely mined out.

Dragons have been accused of stealing precious jewels from humans for thousands of years. But what if we got it wrong? Dragons are known to be protectors of the Earth, so is it possible that humans stole these mineral treasures from the ground and dragons are just putting them back where they belong? Here are some of Earth's most precious jewels, and where you might find them.



Gems from the Earth

The Earth is made up of four layers. Most of the precious minerals are mined from the crust, but diamond and peridot are formed in the mantle.

Peridot

A beautiful olive-green stone that is sometimes found in meteorites.



Diamond

Diamonds are best known as jewels but they are also used for other purposes such as saws and drills.

